With my old carpet-bag under my arm, I came to New Bedford on a black December Saturday, too late for the Nantucket packet.



My mind was made up for a Nantucket craft, so I had a night, a day, and another night to eat and sleep as cheaply as I could.




With only a few pieces of silver in my pocket, I passed the bright, jolly inns and kept waterward.

In the dark streets I stumbled into a smoky church, found no bed there, and backed out again.


At last I found the creaking Spouter-Inn, with Peter Coffin's name beneath the sign, and took it for the cheap spot I needed.



No more blubbering; I scraped the ice from my frosted feet and went in to see what sort of place this Spouter might be.